



The Midwest

SOMETIMES CALLED “HEARTLAND US,” the Midwestern region includes

the legendary plains that roll across states like Nebraska and North and South Dakota, the fertile farming lands that typify Kansas, Iowa, Oklahoma, and Wisconsin, and the Great Lakes states lying farther east, with their huge industrial centers.

TWIN CITIES

Spanning the Mississippi River, the Minnesota cities of Minneapolis and St. Paul are collectively known as the Twin Cities. Traditionally called “the last city of the East,” St. Paul sits directly opposite Minneapolis (shown here), “the first city of the West.”



ALL THAT JAZZ

The establishment of a strong jazz culture in the large Midwestern cities came from the huge migration of Southern black workers in the early 20th century. Here, the tradition is carried on in a Chicago jazz club.



Traditional American footballs are made from pigskin.

Iowa is a predominantly agricultural state containing hundreds of small farming communities like this one.



FOOTBALL

Like most small boys, these Micro League players are passionate about football. This is a fairly violent sport, but all participants wear tough helmets and thick padding. Football fans tend to support their local team; important Midwest teams include the Green Bay Packers (Wisconsin), the Cleveland Browns (Ohio), the Chicago Cubs (Illinois), and the St. Louis Rams (Missouri).